法老的诅咒

The Curse of the Pharaoh



法老的诅咒，经得起证据检验吗？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

On 4 November 1922, in the Valley of the Kings, labourers engaged by the archaeologist Howard Carter uncovered a staircase carved into the rock. On 26 November, with his wealthy sponsor Lord Carnarvon beside him, Carter made a small hole in the sealed doorway and glimpsed the glittering gold of the boy king Tutankhamun. The spectacular find riveted the world.

Carnarvon sold exclusive rights to The Times, a monopoly that left competing reporters starved of news. Many resorted to speculation or sought outside commentators. In March 1923 the best-selling novelist Marie Corelli warned publicly that dire punishment awaited anyone who entered a sealed tomb. Within a fortnight, her words would seem uncanny.

That month a mosquito bit Carnarvon. He nicked the bite with a razor while shaving, it turned septic, and blood poisoning led to pneumonia. He died in Cairo on 5 April 1923. Newspapers reported that the city's lights failed at that instant and that his dog in England howled and died. Yet blackouts were almost a daily occurrence in Cairo.

No curse inscription was ever found in the tomb. In December 2002 a British Medical Journal study traced the fate of 44 Westerners in Egypt at the time. The 25 exposed to the tomb died at an average age of 70, versus 75 for the rest, a margin not statistically significant. The mortality figures lent the ominous rumour no credibility.

Carnarvon's untimely demise had fuelled the tale, giving it impetus. Carter, the excavator who had unsealed the burial place, died in March 1939, aged 64, almost sixteen years after his patron. The legend had left him conspicuously unharmed.

中文译文

1922年11月4日，在埃及帝王谷，考古学家霍华德·卡特雇用的工人发现了一段凿入岩石的阶梯。11月26日，富有的赞助人卡纳冯勋爵站在身旁，卡特在封住的入口上开了一个小孔，瞥见少年国王图坦卡蒙墓中闪耀的黄金。这一惊人发现吸引了全世界的目光。

卡纳冯将独家报道权卖给《泰晤士报》，使其他竞争记者严重缺少消息。许多人转而猜测，或向外界评论者寻求说法。1923年3月，畅销小说家玛丽·科雷利公开警告，任何进入封闭陵墓的人都会受到可怕的惩罚。不到两周，她的话就将显得诡异。

当月，一只蚊子叮了卡纳冯。他刮胡子时用剃刀划破叮咬处，伤口感染化脓，随后败血症引发肺炎。1923年4月5日，他在开罗去世。报纸声称，就在他去世的一刻，开罗全城停电，他在英国的狗也嚎叫着死去。然而，停电在当时的开罗几乎天天发生。

墓中从未发现过诅咒铭文。2002年12月，《英国医学杂志》的一项研究追溯了当时身在埃及的44名西方人的命运。接触过陵墓的25人平均享年70岁，其余人平均75岁，这一差距在统计上并不显著。死亡统计并未为那则不祥的传闻提供可信依据。

卡纳冯的过早离世助长了诅咒传说，使它越传越广。但亲自打开陵墓的发掘者卡特，直到1939年3月才去世，享年64岁，比赞助人的去世时间晚了近16年。这位开墓者却明显没有遭遇传说中的灾祸。

近16年指两人去世日期的间隔，并不是两人的寿命相差16年。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

sponsor n.
赞助人；资助者
his wealthy sponsor Lord Carnarvon

rivet v.
牢牢吸引注意力
The spectacular find riveted the world

exclusive adj.
独家的；专属的
sold exclusive rights

monopoly n.
垄断；独占
a monopoly

be starved of 动词短语
严重缺少
reporters starved of news

resort to 动词短语
转而采用；诉诸
resorted to speculation

speculation n.
猜测；推测
resorted to speculation

dire adj.
可怕的；极其严重的
dire punishment

fortnight n.
两周
Within a fortnight

uncanny adj.
诡异的；不可思议的
her words would seem uncanny

turn septic 动词短语
感染化脓
it turned septic

pneumonia n.
肺炎
blood poisoning led to pneumonia

inscription n.
铭文；刻文
No curse inscription

be exposed to 动词短语
接触到
The 25 exposed to the tomb

margin n.
差距；差额
a margin not statistically significant

significant adj.
（统计上）显著的
not statistically significant

mortality n.
死亡情况；死亡统计
The mortality figures

credibility n.
可信度
no credibility

demise n.
去世；死亡
Carnarvon's untimely demise

fuel v.
助长；促使加剧
had fuelled the tale

impetus n.
推动力
giving it impetus

conspicuously adv.
显眼地；格外醒目地
conspicuously unharmed

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共32项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

labourer n.
工人；体力劳动者

engage v.
雇用；聘请

uncover v.
发现；发掘

staircase n.
楼梯；阶梯

carve into 动词短语
雕凿于；刻入

wealthy adj.
富有的

doorway n.
门口；入口

glittering adj.
闪闪发光的

spectacular adj.
惊人的；壮观的

competing adj.
相互竞争的

commentator n.
评论者

best-selling adj.
畅销的

punishment n.
惩罚

tomb n.
陵墓

mosquito n.
蚊子

nick v.
轻轻划破；割破

razor n.
剃刀

shave v.
刮胡子

at that instant 介词短语
就在那一瞬间

howl v.
嚎叫

blackout n.
停电

occurrence n.
发生的事；事件

fate n.
命运；遭遇

versus prep.
与……相比

ominous adj.
不祥的

rumour n.
传闻；谣言

untimely adj.
过早的；不合时宜的

excavator n.
发掘者

unseal v.
启封；打开封口

burial n.
埋葬；墓葬

patron n.
资助人；赞助人

unharmed adj.
未受伤害的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Carnarvon sold exclusive rights to The Times, a _____ that left competing reporters starved of news.

02 Many resorted to _____ or sought outside commentators.

03 No curse _____ was ever found in the tomb.

04 The mortality figures lent the ominous rumour no _____.

文章主线

- 发现 1922年，卡特与赞助人卡纳冯发现图坦卡蒙墓，墓中珍宝震惊世界。
- 传言 《泰晤士报》买断报道，其他记者转向猜测；卡纳冯次年去世，诅咒故事随之盛行。
- 病因 卡纳冯剃破蚊叮处，感染后发生败血症和肺炎；报纸所述停电，在开罗本就几乎天天发生。
- 对照 研究追踪44人：接触墓的25人平均活70岁，其余75岁，这点差距仍可能来自偶然。
- 结论 墓中从未发现诅咒铭文；卡纳冯死后，亲自开墓的卡特又活了近16年，现有证据不支持诅咒。

参考答案　1 monopoly 2 speculation 3 inscription 4 credibility